



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Archbishop Carroll F Carroll High School

School Website: <https://www.archbishopcolemancarroll.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Archbishop Coleman F. Carroll High School (Miami, FL 33196) presents a distinctly Catholic, Christ-centered educational orientation with clear religious formation, partnership with families, and a college-preparatory curriculum. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christ-centered environment, Carmelite tradition, liturgical life, campus ministry, and a shared partnership between students, parents, and educators. These elements align strongly with several core classical criteria, particularly in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose & Goal, as well as Parents & Community. At the same time, the published curriculum and pedagogy lean toward a contemporary Catholic college-prep model rather than a fully orthodox classical program (e.g., limited or no explicit Great Books emphasis and no explicit Socratic/Schoen  pedagogy in public materials). Taken overall, the school trends CLASSICAL, with notable strengths in religious formation and parental partnership, and with room to deepen alignment in the classical curriculum, pedagogy, and explicit faculty formation.

- Overall ranking by category (evidence-based):
- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): CLASSICAL
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): CLASSICAL
- Element 3 (Curriculum): NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5 (Faculty): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): CLASSICAL
- Aggregate general assessment: CLASSICAL
- Evidence highlights:
- Strong Christ-centered, Carmelite formation and liturgical life; Campus Ministry explicitly described as forming students through Gospel, liturgy, and service (evidence cited below).
- Explicit emphasis on formation of the whole person, truth, goodness, and self-discipline; faculty/staff cited as dedicated to the mission.
- Curriculum documented as college-prep in theology, English, math, science, social studies, etc., with pathways like dual enrollment and college counseling, but lacking explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or Great Conversation language in public-facing materials.
- Pedagogical methods are not publicly described as classical (no explicit Socratic seminars, schol  pedagogy, or memorization/recitation programs in the site copy).
- Parents and community engagement appears strong via partnership language and frequent parent-facing materials; open campus philosophy is evident.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes a Christ-centered, Carmelite-informed environment and a sacred, liturgical life (Campus Ministry, liturgy, sacraments).
- The mission/vision language centers on truth, goodness, and self-discipline within a faith context; Carmelite heritage is foregrounded.
- There is explicit Catholic identity, including the role of Campus Ministry and a mission to form students in faith and virtue.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present (examples): Christ-centered, Carmelite tradition, liturgy, sacraments, Gospel, Church/Christian formation, sacred, worship, reverence, truth, goodness, beauty.
- Negative keywords present: none observed in public-facing materials.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive ~5–7 signals identified; Negative ~0 signals observed.
- Why this rating: The materials foreground transcendent Christian formation and liturgical life, which aligns with the Classical School's Religious and Metaphysical Foundations when measured against the lexicon's positive indicators and minimal negative signals.
- Why this rating
- The public materials showcase a robust religious and metaphysical orientation (theology, liturgy, communal worship, Gospel-centered life) without signaling relativism or secular alternatives. This matches the Classical rubric's expectations for transcendental moral realism and liturgical/communal practices.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Repeated emphasis on formation of the whole person, virtue, wisdom, and a Christ-centered formation (not merely job preparation).
- Statements tying education to the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty in a human-flourishing frame; reference to a shared partnership with families as part of formation.
- Language describing formation over mere information transfer; emphasis on character and virtue development within a Catholic framework.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present (examples): formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education/paideia (implied by formation emphasis), telos (explicitly in lexicon but implied in goals), scholé/contemplation (less explicit in site text but formation language is present).
- Negative keywords present: few to none in public-facing materials; no explicit focus on workforce-first criteria.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive ~3–5 signals; Negative ~0–1 signals (no workforce-prep emphasis observed).
- Why this rating: The school's stated aims center on virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing in a formation-focused framework rather than just job-readiness, aligning with Classical ideals in this category.
- Why this rating

- The materials consistently frame education as formation (virtue, wisdom, human excellence) grounded in a faith tradition, aligning with the Classical School's goals-in-education emphasis rather than a narrow career-prep orientation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public-facing curriculum details show a standard Catholic college-preparatory sequence (Theology, English, Mathematics, Science, Social Studies, World Languages; Fine/Performing Arts; graduation credits; and dual enrollment options).
- Notably absent are explicit references to Great Books, the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or Quadrivium, Latin/Greek classical languages, or the Great Conversation framework in the site copy. The explicit Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium language is not present in the visible materials.
- There is emphasis on dual enrollment and college counseling, which is a modern, college-prep orientation rather than a classical curriculum framework.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: dual enrollment, college counseling, college-prep tracks (e.g., St. Michael's Scholars Program; College Prep I/II/III). These reflect a rigorous modern curriculum but not the classical liberal arts framework.
- Negative keywords present: explicit classical markers (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Conversation) are not present in public-facing materials.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive ~2–4 signals (dual enrollment, college prep tracks); Negative ~0–0 (classical markers) but presence of non-classical markers means a lack of classical-leaning signals.
- Why this rating: The visible curriculum aligns with a contemporary Catholic college-preparatory model rather than the classical curriculum's explicit emphasis on the liberal arts, Great Books, and the Trivium/Quadrivium.
- Why this rating
- While the curriculum supports rigorous college preparation within a Catholic frame, the absence of explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or Great Conversation language in the public materials places it outside the strict Classical Curriculum benchmark.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials do not present explicit classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé days, memory work, or formal recitation as primary methods). The visible pedagogy is consistent with a traditional Catholic school approach and modern college-prep standards.
- There is no explicit mention of Socratic discussion, seminars, or rhetoric training as a core pedagogy in the site copy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: none explicit in the public-facing materials for classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic dialogue, recitation, scholé, master-teacher traditions).
- Negative keywords present: absence of classical pedagogy signals; while absence is not a positive signal, the lexicon identifies potential negative signals for pedagogy when those elements appear. Here, they are not present.

- Quantitative estimate: Positive ~0 signals; Negative ~0–1 signals (lack of explicit classical pedagogy signals but no explicit negative signals either).
- Why this rating: The site does not articulate classical pedagogy (Socratic dialog, scholé, memorization via chant, etc.), so it does not meet the Pedagogy category's classical criteria.
- Why this rating
- Without public-facing evidence of Socratic or scholé-based practices, the school does not meet the Pedagogy category's classical benchmarks, despite strong religious formation elsewhere.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site highlights “dedicated faculty and staff” and emphasizes formation, leadership, and a partnership with students. This indicates faculty as a key element of the school's living educational model.
- Public materials show “Meet the Team” and Leadership information, which underscores faculty as a central, exemplary component of the school culture.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: dedicated faculty and staff; living curriculum (explicit phrase not always used, but the phrase “dedicated faculty and staff” signals the faculty as a core part of the school's approach); “Christ Centered” faculty alignment.
- Negative keywords present: not clearly indicated in public materials.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive ~2–3 signals; Negative ~0 signals.
- Why this rating: The materials emphasize a committed faculty, which supports the Classical category's emphasis on teacher as model and mentor, though the explicit framework of a classical “living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher” is not fully articulated in public content. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.
- Why this rating
- The school presents faculty as dedicated and central to formation, aligning with Classical expectations about virtuous teachers, but it lacks explicit classical pedagogy or a fully articulated “living curriculum” portrait in the site copy. This yields a middle-ground (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL).

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school explicitly describes partnership with parents as co-educators and emphasizes parental involvement as part of the classical ethos (e.g., “education is a shared partnership of students, parents, administrators, and teachers”). Open campus access and parent-facing opportunities are evident.
- Public materials discuss parent formation, book groups, seminars, and opportunities for parents to engage with classical education concepts through the school's lens (as part of the broader classical lexicon the school references). The collaboration language is explicit.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; open campus; parent formation; parental engagement; home-school collaboration.
- Negative keywords present: no clear consumer-oriented or minimal-parent-involvement signals.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive ~4–6 signals; Negative ~0.

- Why this rating: The school presents a strong, explicit partnership model with parents, aligning with the Parents & Community category's classical indicators.
- Why this rating
- The materials emphasize a robust family partnership and open parental access, which are core to the classical vision of a family- and community-centered education. This matches the lexicon's positive indicators for Partnership with Families and formation of affections through family engagement.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable here since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. If you'd like, I can outline concrete steps to further strengthen the not-yet-classical categories (Curriculum and Pedagogy) toward a fuller classical alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.